1. Is reducing the number of crossing edges the only criterion we should follow?
2. We know not all graphs are planar… should we just give up on non-planar graphs?

Let’s focus on the first question: what do you think? Take a minute to imagine what other characteristics make a good visualization, and vice versa what could go wrong with this.

Then take a look at figure 15.11, to corroborate your thoughts.

Looking at it, there are at least three different aspects that contribute to the poor look and comprehensibility of the visualization:

1. The most evident effect is that it’s impossible to read any text: this is because elements are unnecessarily far from each other, and we need to zoom out to see the whole chart;
2. Some edges are all twisted and windy, making it harder to follow them;
3. With respect to figure 15.1, the relative position of the elements fails to suggest the direction of flow: adjacent nodes are far from each other, with nodes modeling other unrelated steps in-between.